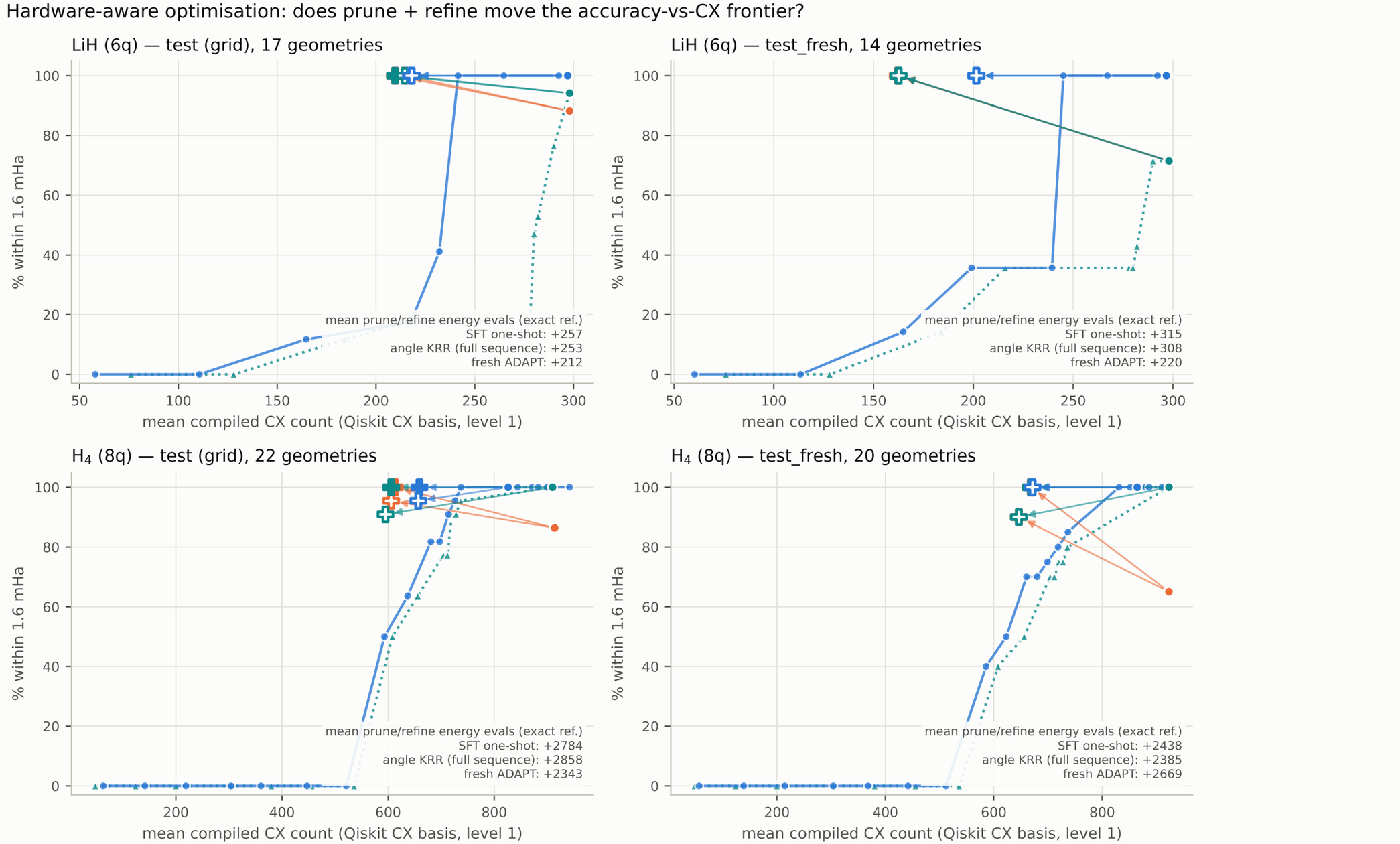

Small dot = start circuit as generated; arrow = greedy prune + BFGS refine to stay within 1.6 mHa (filled: exact FCI reference; hollow: reference-free, tolerance chosen on VAL).
Lines are zero-evaluation KRR prefixes and truncated ADAPT (fig7). Prune/refine spends energy evaluations (panel text): a different cost class from one-shot. SFT and KRR starts share the canonical sequence, so after refinement their points coincide.

- angle KRR on canonical n-op prefixes (one-shot)
- ADAPT truncated at k ops (fresh run, re-optimised; runs that stopped earlier drop out)
- SFT one-shot + prune/refine (exact reference)
- SFT one-shot + prune/refine (reference-free)
- angle KRR (full sequence) + prune/refine (exact reference)
- angle KRR (full sequence) + prune/refine (reference-free)
- fresh ADAPT + prune/refine (exact reference)
- fresh ADAPT + prune/refine (reference-free)